

Figure 2: A data flow diagram for Autotools

```

config.status configure.ac depcomp INSTALL Makefile.am NEWS
$ automake
$ ls
aclocal.m4 autom4te.cache ChangeLog config.log configure COPYING
hello.c install-sh Makefile.in NEWS AUTHORS autotools.log
config.h.in config.status configure.ac depcomp INSTALL Makefile.am
missing README
  
```

So, *Makefile.in* has been automatically created using *automake*.

Bringing together *autoconf* and *automake*

Let's now do the steps once again with *autoconf* and *automake*. Create *hello_world.c* and *Makefile.am* as described above. Then run the following:

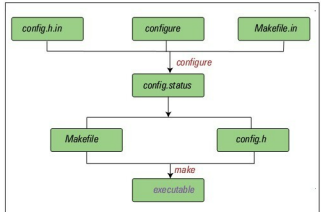
```

$ autoscan
$ mv configure.scan configure.ac
$ autoheader
  
```

Edit your *configure.ac* and add `AM_INIT_AUTOMAKE`. Then run the following:

```

$ aclocal
$ automake --add-missing
$ touch NEWS README AUTHORS ChangeLog
$ automake
$ autoconf
$ ./configure
$ make
  
```

Figure 3: A data flow diagram for *configure* and *make*

```
$ ./hello_world
```

What's next?

Here I discussed a trivial 'hello world' program, which doesn't actually represent Autotools' complexity nor the portability gained by using it. Instead, I described how to use Autotools. When you create your own code, you can add portability in the way described above.  **END**

References

- [1] Autoconf manual: <http://www.gnu.org/software/autoconf/manual/autoconf.html>
- [2] Automake manual: <http://www.gnu.org/software/automake/manual/automake.html>
- [3] Autotools: A Practitioner's Guide to GNU Autoconf, Automake, and Libtool, by John Calvotte
- [4] <http://markuskimius.wikidot.com/programming:tut:autotools>

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